BBC

Speakout

3RD EDITION



Literature Lessons Teaching Notes

INTRODUCTION

The thinking behind *Literature Lessons*

Each level of ***Speakout 3rd Edition Student's Book and Workbook*** offers two readings selected from a ***Pearson English Reader***. ***Pearson English Readers*** are specially adapted to suit the vocabulary and grammar level of the students, with new words highlighted and presented with a glossary. First and foremost, reading is presented as an enjoyable end in itself, so students can read unhindered by new vocabulary which often disturbs the reading flow. The extracts all focus on an interesting part of the text to encourage students to ask what happens next to the characters they have met.

The books chosen also tie in with the themes of the Students' Book unit and offer students a chance to engage with those themes in a different way. In keeping with the name of the course, speaking activities based on the literature selection feature, alongside activities designed to test comprehension, explore the themes of the text, and stimulate an interest in the literature itself. Each text is accompanied by tasks to build on the reading material. Below we will briefly explain our approach to each task type.

HARVARD'S PROJECT ZERO

Harvard's Project Zero (http://www.pz.harvard.edu) underpins much of the thinking behind the *Literature Lessons*. This fifty-year initiative aims to promote critical thinking, curiosity and creativity through the use of research-based classroom practice.

Each *Literature Lesson* begins with a *Thinking Routine* broken up into three parts: *See*, *Think*, *Wonder*, to engage students with the topic of the extract in a way that makes thinking visible.

The *Thinking Routine* may start with an image or topic that calls for students to observe and describe, followed by questions to make them think about what the reasons might be for what they can see and to wonder about the topic.

PROVA INVALSI

The activities used to test comprehension of the text extract follow the guidelines for the Prova INVALSI. There are fi ve types of tasks and each *Literature Lesson* utilises one task type, so that all fi ve are covered. The task types are as follows:

- Multiple-choice questions (with four options)
- Questions requiring short answers (2–5 words)
- True/False/Not Given questions
- Matching (e.g. matching character names with actions, or matching headings to paragraphs)
- Cloze (based on summaries of the text or sentences about

CLIL

CLIL – or *Content and Language Integrated Learning* – enables students to gain vocabulary, skills and confi dence in the language through the study of traditional academic subjects. Some of the tasks based on the text have been designed to bring out CLIL topics which may include history, geography, science, sociology, I.T., citizenship or literature.

ACTIVE INVESTIGATION

Active Investigation tasks involve students doing research on a topic suggested by the selected text or the overall lesson. We ask students to fi nd out more, perhaps working in pairs or groups, and to record and organise the data they fi nd. One or more questions focus on a CLIL topic and most can be carried out partly or wholly outside of class with the aid of the internet or books.

21ST CENTURY SKILLS DEVELOPMENT

The tasks aim to develop students' 21st century skills. Students work collaboratively to promote their own initiative and communication skills essential to the modern workplace. We have designed tasks that practise students' critical thinking skills such as reacting to and discussing findings, drawing conclusions and using the results of research to refl ect on answers to questions in the *Thinking Routine* section. Carrying out the research develops information and media literacy, as collecting data may require a narrowing down of sources through evaluation and critical examination.

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AGENDA 2030

The 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development was launched by a UN Summit in 2015, where world leaders agreed to 17 Global Goals. These goals have the power to create a better world by 2030, by ending poverty, fighting inequality and addressing the urgency of climate change.

Some Literature Lessons in Speakout have a theme which can be linked to one of the 17 Goals of the United Nations. The icon of the goal is on the page. The 17 goals are:



For more information about the objectives of each goal please visit the website https://sdgs.un.org/goals

OVERVIEW

Each *Literature Lesson* is a richly illustrated two-page spread designed to evoke the era, mood and themes of the selected extract. Each spread is usually organised in the same way, with occasional variations on the order of task types after the *Comprehension* activity. The extracts are recorded, so students can listen as well as read. In addition, each reading text is followed by a Listening extract which complements the reading.

We have selected texts from the following Pearson English Readers:

Alice in Wonderland by Lewis Carroll (A2–A2+)
Gandhi by Jane Rollason (A2–A2+)
White Fang by Jack London (A2–A2+)
Persuasion by Jane Austen (A2–A2+)
An Ideal Husband by Oscar Wilde (A2+–B1)
Stories of Courage by Clare Gray (A2+–B1)
Leonardo da Vinci by Georgia Clarke (B1–B2)
The Time Machine by HG Wells (B1–B2)
The Strange Case of Dr Jekyll and Mr Hyde by Robert Louis Stevenson (B1+–B2+)
Middlemarch by George Eliot (B1+–B2+)

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ALICE IN WONDERLAND by Lewis Carroll (A2–A2+) LITERATURE LESSON

1



PREPARATION

1 **Look and the book cover and answer the questions:**

see

1 What can you see in the picture?
2 Describe the girl.

think

3 Who do you think she is?
4 How does the picture make you feel?

wonder

5 What do you think the picture means?
6 The picture is like something from a dream. Do dreams ever mean something?

2

Alice gets taller

Then she saw a little box under the table. She opened it. There was a cake inside. On it, she saw the words, 'EAT ME'.

'Yes, I will eat it,' Alice said. 'Perhaps I'll get bigger. Or perhaps I'll get smaller.'

She ate some cake. 'Will I go up or down?' she wondered. 'Oh! I'm getting taller and taller!' She looked down. 'Goodbye, feet! Who will put your shoes on for you now? I can't do it! I'll give you some new shoes for Christmas. I'll have to send them to you!'

In a short time, Alice was more than three metres high.

'I want to go into that garden!' she thought. She took the little key from the table. Then she went to the door and opened it. But she was too big and couldn't go through it. She sat down and began to cry. Because she was very big, her **tears** were very big too.

'Alice, stop it this minute! Don't cry!' she said. But she couldn't stop the big tears and after a time there was water everywhere. Then, she heard the sound of small feet. She looked down and there was the White Rabbit again. He had his best clothes on, and in one hand he had a white hat.

'Oh, the **Duchess**!' he said. 'She'll be angry with me because I'm late!'

Alice wanted to ask him for help. 'Please, Sir –' she said very **politely**.

The White Rabbit jumped and ran out of the room.

'Am I different?' she wondered. 'I was Alice yesterday, but everything is different today. Perhaps I'm not me now. So who am I? That's the question.'

3

GLOSSARY
tear *n.* water that falls from your eyes when you're sad
Duchess *n.* higher than a Lady but lower than a Queen
politely *adv.* in a nice way

4

COMPREHENSION

2 LL1.01 **Listen and read the text. Are the statements true (T), false (F) or not given (NG)?**

1 Alice is hungry. .....
2 Alice doesn't know what will happen when she eats the cake. .....
3 Alice can't open the door to the garden. .....
4 This is not the first time Alice sees the White Rabbit. .....
5 The Duchess is always angry with the White Rabbit. .....
6 Alice is not sure where she is. .....

5

6

ACTIVE INVESTIGATION

3 **The story of Alice in Wonderland is all a dream Alice is having. Many people have these dreams. What do you think they mean? Find out what other people think they mean.**

1 you are falling
2 you are flying
3 your teeth are falling out

7

SPEAKING

4 **Work in small groups. Do you have the same answers to Ex 3? What other dreams are common? What do you think these mean?**

8

CLIL CONNECTION
Literature

5A **Alice in Wonderland was one of the first children's books. Lewis Carroll wrote it in 1865. Find out about these other very famous children's books.**

Peter Pan The Princess and the Goblin
The Wind in the Willows

1 Who wrote them and when did they write them?
2 What are the stories about?

B **What are the most important children's books now? Why are they important?**

1 *Thinking Routine* gets students thinking about the themes and ideas of the extract before reading.

2 *Extracts* are approximately 300 words, with glossed words in **bold**.

3 The *Glossary* of all words above B1 level include the part of speech and a defi nition of the word in the context it appears.

4 *Comprehension* tasks practise INVALSI exam skills and test students' understanding of what they have read.

5 Listening gives Ss a taste for the drama of the story with a 'What happens next?' audio extract while practising listening skills.

6 *Active Investigation* helps students build research skills and engage further with the topics and themes in the extract.

7 *Speakout* tasks provide an opportunity to talk about their research or their thoughts about some aspect of the book the extract is from.

8 *CLIL Connection* highlights a theme from the book that is linked to an academic subject.

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